

English – Marathi Relationship Glossary

(C-CAT Blood Relations — Companion Reference)

This glossary covers every relationship term used in Blood Relations questions, with its proper Marathi word, pronunciation, and a short example using तुमची आई / बहीण / भाऊ so the meaning is immediately clear — not just a dictionary definition.

How to use this: Marathi has *separate words* for relations that English lumps under one term (like "uncle" or "cousin"). Once you know the Marathi word, the English term usually stops being confusing — because Marathi tells you exactly *which side of the family* and *whose relative* it is.

1. Immediate Family (जवळचे कुटुंब)

English	Marathi	Pronunciation	Meaning / Example
Father	वडील / बाबा	Vadil / Baba	तुमचे वडील — तुमच्या जन्माला कारणीभूत पुरुष.
Mother	आई	Aai	तुमची आई.
Son	मुलगा	Mulga	तुमचा मुलगा.
Daughter	मुलगी	Mulgi	तुमची मुलगी.
Brother	भाऊ	Bhau	तुमचा सख्खा भाऊ (same parents).
Sister	बहीण	Bahin	तुमची सख्खी बहीण.
Husband	नवरा / पती	Navra / Pati	तुमच्या बहिणीचा नवरा — तिचा पती.
Wife	बायको / पत्नी	Baiko / Patni	तुमच्या भावाची बायको.
Grandfather (paternal)	आजोबा	Ajoba	वडिलांचे वडील.
Grandmother (paternal)	आजी	Aji	वडिलांची आई.
Grandfather (maternal)	आजोबा (आईचे वडील)	Aaiche Ajoba	आईचे वडील — काही भागात "मामंजी आजोबा" असेही म्हणतात, पण सर्वसामान्यपणे आजोबा हाच शब्द वापरतात.
Grandmother (maternal)	आजी (आईची आई)	Aaichi Aji	आईची आई.
Grandson	नातू	Natu	तुमच्या मुलाचा/मुलीचा मुलगा.
Granddaughter	नात	Naat	तुमच्या मुलाची/मुलीची

English	Marathi	Pronunciation	Meaning / Example
			मुलगी.
Great-grandfather	पणजोबा	Panajoba	आजोबांचे वडील.
Great-grandmother	पणजी	Panaji	आजोबांची आई.
Great-grandson	पणतू	Panatu	नातवाचा मुलगा.
Great-granddaughter	पणती	Panati	नातवाची मुलगी.

2. Uncle / Aunt — चार वेगळे शब्द, एकच इंग्रजी शब्द! (This is the #1 confusion point)

English has just **one** word "uncle" and **one** word "aunt" for four completely different people. Marathi doesn't — it tells you immediately which side of the family they're from.

English	Marathi	Pronunciation	Exactly who is this?
Uncle (father's brother) — Paternal Uncle	काका	Kaka	तुमच्या वडिलांचा भाऊ.
Aunt (father's sister) — Paternal Aunt	आत्या	Aatya	तुमच्या वडिलांची बहीण.
Uncle (mother's brother) — Maternal Uncle	मामा	Mama	तुमच्या आईचा भाऊ.
Aunt (mother's sister) — Maternal Aunt	मावशी	Mavshi	तुमच्या आईची बहीण.
Aunt (wife of काका, i.e. father's brother's wife)	काकी / काकू	Kaki / Kaku	काकांची बायको.
Uncle (husband of आत्या, i.e. father's sister's husband)	काका (किंवा भावोजी)	Kaka / Bhavoji	आत्याचा नवरा.
Aunt (wife of मामा, i.e. mother's brother's wife)	मामी	Mami	मामांची बायको.
Uncle (husband of मावशी, i.e. mother's sister's husband)	मावसा	Mavasa	मावशीचा नवरा.

Exam Trick: If a C-CAT question says "paternal uncle," it always means काका. If it says "maternal uncle," it always means मामा. The English word alone ("uncle") is ambiguous — but the *qualifier* (paternal/maternal) tells you exactly which Marathi word applies. Always look for that qualifier first.

3. Cousins — चुलत, मामे, मावस, आत्ये भाऊ-बहीण (Another major confusion point)

English has just one word, "cousin," for **any** child of your uncle or aunt. Marathi has **four different words** depending on which uncle/aunt:

Whose child?	Marathi (Male Cousin)	Marathi (Female Cousin)	Example
काका (father's brother)'s child	चुलत भाऊ (Chulat Bhau)	चुलत बहीण (Chulat Bahin)	काकांचा मुलगा/मुलगी.
मामा (mother's brother)'s child	मामे भाऊ (Mame Bhau)	मामे बहीण (Mame Bahin)	मामांचा मुलगा/मुलगी.
मावशी (mother's sister)'s child	मावस भाऊ (Mavas Bhau)	मावस बहीण (Mavas Bahin)	मावशीचा मुलगा/मुलगी.
आत्या (father's sister)'s child	आत्ये भाऊ / आत्तेभाऊ (Aatte Bhau)	आत्ये बहीण / आत्तेबहीण (Aatte Bahin)	आत्याचा मुलगा/मुलगी.

Note: In everyday spoken Marathi, people often just say "भाऊ" or "बहीण" even for cousins (since culturally cousins are treated almost like siblings). The specific words above (चुलत/मामे/मावस/आत्ये) are used when you need to be precise — which is exactly what C-CAT questions test.

4. Nephew / Niece — भाचा/भाची vs पुतण्या/पुतणी (Depends on YOUR gender too!)

This is genuinely one of the trickiest parts of Marathi kinship — the correct word depends on **whether the speaker is male or female**, not just on whose child it is.

English	Situation	Marathi	Pronunciation
Nephew (sister's son)	Said by anyone (brother or sister)	भाचा	Bhacha
Niece (sister's daughter)	Said by anyone	भाची	Bhachi
Nephew (brother's son)	If you are male (i.e., his brother)	पुतण्या	Putanya
Niece (brother's daughter)	If you are male	पुतणी	Putani
Nephew (brother's son)	If you are female (i.e., his sister)	भाचा	Bhacha
Niece (brother's daughter)	If you are female	भाची	Bhachi

Simple rule to remember: Your **sister's** children are *always* भाचा/भाची to you, no matter your gender. Your **brother's** children are पुतण्या/पुतणी *only if you are also male* (his brother); if you are female (his sister), they're भाचा/भाची to you too.

5. In-Laws Through Your Marriage — सासरचे नातेवाईक

These are relationships you gain *after marriage*, through your spouse's family.

English	Marathi	Pronunciation	Meaning
Father-in-law	सासरे	Sasre	तुमच्या नवऱ्याचे/बायकोचे वडील.
Mother-in-law	सासू	Sasu	तुमच्या नवऱ्याची/बायकोची आई.
Son-in-law	जावई	Jawai	तुमच्या मुलीचा नवरा.
Daughter-in-law	सून	Soon	तुमच्या मुलाची बायको.

Brother-in-law — Marathi has up to FOUR different words for this one English term:

English Phrase	Exactly Who	Marathi	Pronunciation
Brother-in-law (husband's <i>elder</i> brother)	नवऱ्याचा मोठा भाऊ	दीर	Deer
Brother-in-law (husband's <i>younger</i> brother)	नवऱ्याचा लहान भाऊ	दीर (किंवा देवर)	Deer / Devar
Brother-in-law (wife's brother)	बायकोचा भाऊ	मेहुणा	Mehuna
Brother-in-law (sister's husband)	बहिणीचा नवरा	मेहुणा / दाजी	Mehuna / Daji
Brother-in-law (wife's sister's husband)	बायकोच्या बहिणीचा नवरा	साडू	Sadu

Sister-in-law — also has multiple words:

English Phrase	Exactly Who	Marathi	Pronunciation
Sister-in-law (husband's sister)	नवऱ्याची बहीण	नणंद	Nanand
Sister-in-law (wife's sister)	बायकोची बहीण	मेहुणी	Mehuni

English Phrase	Exactly Who	Marathi	Pronunciation
Sister-in-law (brother's wife, <i>elder</i> brother)	मोठ्या भावाची बायको	वहिनी	Vahini
Sister-in-law (brother's wife, <i>younger</i> brother)	लहान भावाची बायको	भावजय	Bhavjay
Sister-in-law (husband's brother's wife)	नवऱ्याच्या भावाची बायको	जाऊ	Jaau

Exam Trick: In C-CAT, when you see "brother-in-law" or "sister-in-law" in a question, the answer choices will usually just say "Brother-in-law" in English — you don't need to pick the exact Marathi word. But *understanding* that दीर ≠ मेहुणा ≠ साडू helps you correctly trace **which side of the family** the relation is on, which is what actually matters for solving the puzzle.

6. Other Useful In-Law / Extended Terms

English	Marathi	Pronunciation	Meaning
Co-brother-in-law (your wife's sister's husband — same as above, repeated for clarity)	साडू	Sadu	दोन बहिणींचे नवरे एकमेकांना "साडू" म्हणतात.
Co-sister-in-law (two brothers' wives, to each other)	जाऊ	Jaau	दोन भावांच्या बायका एकमेकींना "जाऊ" म्हणतात.
Father of your son's/daughter's spouse (व्याही)	व्याही	Vyahi	तुमच्या सुनेचे/जावयाचे वडील.
Mother of your son's/daughter's spouse	विहीण	Vihin	तुमच्या सुनेची/जावयाची आई.
Grandson's wife	नातसून	Natsoon	नातवाची बायको.
Granddaughter's husband	नातजावई	Natjawai	नातीचा नवरा.

7. Quick Reference — Side-by-Side Summary Table

#	English Term	Marathi Word	Whose relative?
1	Paternal Uncle	काका	Father's brother

#	English Term	Marathi Word	Whose relative?
2	Paternal Aunt	आत्या	Father's sister
3	Maternal Uncle	मामा	Mother's brother
4	Maternal Aunt	मावशी	Mother's sister
5	Cousin (काका's child)	चुलत भाऊ/बहीण	Paternal uncle's child
6	Cousin (मामा's child)	मामे भाऊ/बहीण	Maternal uncle's child
7	Cousin (मावशी's child)	मावस भाऊ/बहीण	Maternal aunt's child
8	Cousin (आत्या's child)	आत्ये भाऊ/बहीण	Paternal aunt's child
9	Nephew/Niece (sister's child)	भाचा / भाची	Sister's child (anyone)
10	Nephew/Niece (brother's child, you're male)	पुतण्या / पुतणी	Brother's child (if you're his brother)
11	Father-in-law	सासरे	Spouse's father
12	Mother-in-law	सासू	Spouse's mother
13	Son-in-law	जावई	Daughter's husband
14	Daughter-in-law	सून	Son's wife
15	Brother-in-law (husband's brother)	दीर	Husband's brother
16	Brother-in-law (wife's brother)	मेहुणा	Wife's brother
17	Brother-in-law (sister's husband)	मेहुणा / दाजी	Sister's husband
18	Sister-in-law (husband's sister)	नणंद	Husband's sister
19	Sister-in-law (wife's sister)	मेहुणी	Wife's sister
20	Sister-in-law (elder brother's wife)	वहिनी	Elder brother's wife
21	Sister-in-law (younger brother's wife)	भावजय	Younger brother's wife

8. How This Helps You Solve C-CAT Questions Faster

Since you already think in Marathi, here's how to use this glossary as a shortcut **during the exam**:

1. **Read the English question, mentally translate the key relation word to Marathi.**

"Maternal uncle" → मामा clicks instantly, while "uncle" alone might make you hesitate.

2. **For coded questions** (like P+Q–R puzzles), translate each decoded step into Marathi in your head — "P is mother of Q" → "P ही Q ची आई आहे" — Marathi sentence structure often makes the family-tree direction (कोण कोणाचे) clearer than English does.
 3. **For "only child" trap questions**, the Marathi phrasing "एकुलता एक मुलगा" (only son) or "एकुलती एक मुलगी" (only daughter) is a dead giveaway — train yourself to spot the English equivalent ("only son," "only daughter," "only child") just as quickly.
 4. **For cousin questions**, if you can identify *which* Marathi cousin-word applies (चुलत/मामे/मावस/आत्ये), you've automatically identified which uncle/aunt is involved — which is usually the hardest part of the question.
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Companion reference for the C-CAT Blood Relations Workbook — Section A, Reasoning.